School bus harness conversation 2025

------------------ Original ------------------

From: [redacted] [redacted]@pta.wa.gov.au>
Date: Thu, Aug 7, 2025 7:44 AM
To: Hanyu [redacted]
Cc: SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>
Subject: Fw: FW: RE: RE: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

OFFICIAL: Sensitive

Hi Hanyu

Thank you for your email about [redacted]

I will answer the below questions to the best of my knowledge and from the information I have on the system.

- 1. **Who originally prescribed and documented the harness use?**
  - The harnesses were organised in June 2022 and all paperwork were signed by all the relevant parties.
- 2. **Was a formal fade-out plan ever developed or considered?**
  - The original request was sent to [redacted] in February 2025 by Hanyu. As the request originated from the parent, it would have been their responsibility to propose and discuss any transition or fade-out plan directly with the bus staff.
- 3. **What is the make, model, and manual for the harness?**
  - Families are typically responsible for purchasing harnesses based on the advice of their medical or support team. As School Bus Services is not provided with this information, you may need to check with your support team or refer to any past receipts or records you may have.

Please let me know if you require any additional information.

[redacted]

Team Leader, Metro | School Bus Services

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From: Hanyu [redacted]
Sent: Monday, 4 August 2025 6:48 PM
To: SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>
Cc: enquire <enquire@pta.wa.gov.au>; [redacted]; School Bus <schoolbus@pta.wa.gov.au>
Subject: Re: RE: RE: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

Dear [redacted],

Thank you for your reply. However, you have not yet responded to the critical questions raised in my previous email regarding:

- 1. Who originally prescribed and documented the harness use?
- 2. Was a formal fade-out plan ever developed or considered?
- 3. What is the make, model, and manual for the harness?

We require **clear, direct responses** to these points as they significantly impact [redacted]'s PBS planning and safety.

If SBS has no records, please explicitly state this.

Please respond clearly to each point within 5 business days. We would prefer to resolve this matter directly with SBS. However, if SBS is unable or unwilling to provide the necessary information, we will escalate our concerns to the Ombudsman.

Warm regards,

Hanyu Liu

------------------ Original ------------------

From: SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>

Date: Mon, Aug 4, 2025 4:01 PM

To: Hanyu <[redacted]

Subject: Re: RE: RE: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

OFFICIAL: Sensitive

Good afternoon Hanyu,

Thank you for your email and the detailed questions provided.

School Bus Services acknowledges our role in ensuring that transport arrangements are appropriate and safe for all students.

If you're looking to explore the option of [redacted] travelling without the harness, please let us know. In that case, we'd need a written support plan outlining the strategies the bus aide can use to help manage any behaviours that may arise such as removing his seatbelt, leaving his seat, or kicking.

[redacted], your PBS practitioner, is also welcome to contact us directly via this email or by phone to explore options further.

We're happy to work collaboratively and will support any reasonable and safe arrangements recommended by qualified professionals.

[redacted]

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------------------ Original ------------------

From: Hanyu [redacted]>
Sent: Tuesday, 29 July 2025 6:28 PM
To: SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>
Cc: [redacted] School Bus <schoolbus@pta.wa.gov.au>
Subject: Re: RE: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

Dear [redacted],

Thank you for your earlier reply.

We appreciate SBS's stated commitment to collaborating with families and qualified professionals. However, several key questions remain unresolved, and we require further information to ensure sound Positive Behaviour Support (PBS) planning and risk management for [redacted]:

1. **Harness Prescription Origin**

- Who **originally prescribed** harness use for [redacted]?
- Was this prescription initiated by SBS or by a previous bus operator (e.g., [redacted])?
- Is there a named **professional or agency** responsible for the clinical recommendation?
- Was the prescription **formally documented?** If so, could you please provide a copy or confirmation?

2. **Fade-Out Plan or Review Schedule**

- Was there a formal **fade-out plan, clinical note, or scheduled review** associated with the original harness prescription?
- If yes, who developed or approved it?
- If not, what is **SBS's standard protocol** for reviewing or revising harness use?

3. **Harness Model and Manual**

- What is the make and **model** of the harness currently in use on the bus?
- Could you please provide the manufacturer's details and the official user manual or product guidelines?
- This information is critical for both our PBS practitioner and in the event of an emergency or equipment issue.

4. **Role of [redacted] (New PBS Practitioner)**

- Our new **PBS practitioner**, [redacted], will be working with us to assess [redacted]'s readiness for potential harness removal.
- Could you please confirm whether she may contact SBS directly, and if so, what is the appropriate **procedure** and contact point?

We understand that SBS does not employ in-house therapists. Nevertheless, since SBS is responsible for *approving, providing, and enforcing use of control devices*, we believe SBS retains *institutional responsibility* for documenting the origins and rationale of such interventions—especially where these decisions directly affect student access to transport.

We kindly request written responses to each of the above points so we can proceed with safe and appropriate planning.

Thank you for your assistance and understanding.

Warm regards,

Hanyu Liu

------------------ Original ------------------

From: SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>

Date: Mon, Mar 17, 2025 4:31 PM

To: Hanyu <[redacted]

Subject: Re: RE: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

Good afternoon,

Thank you for your email and for providing an update on your situation.

School Bus Services do not have in house therapists, and we will communicate with professionals who are involved with students such as school professionals, qualified health care professions and families who will collaboratively work together to come up with behavioural strategies suited for bus travel.

Regarding emergency procedures, the bus service is equipped with a cutting device to ensure the harness can be safely removed in the event of an emergency.

Regarding safety manuals all students arrive to the bus already with their harness on and the bus staff attach the harness to the seat mount as per product instructions.

I hope this answers your queries.

[redacted]

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------------------ Original ------------------

From: Hanyu [redacted]>
Sent: Wednesday, 12 March 2025 1:17 PM
To: SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>
Cc: [redacted]@pta.wa.gov.au>
Subject: Re: RE: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

Hi [redacted],

Thank you for your response and for outlining SBS's approach to safety control devices. I completely understand that the goal is to transition away from harness use in the long term, and we are fully committed to working towards that with the appropriate strategies.

However, as you know, NDIS PBS and therapy funding is very tight, and our main priority is addressing other daily living challenges. Our previous PBS practitioner has just left, and we are currently in the process of finding a new one. Once we have a new practitioner, they will develop a strategy plan—but this will take time. In the meantime, does SBS have in-house therapists who can provide general strategies for managing bus safety?

Additionally, I would like to clarify a few important safety concerns:

1. Emergency Procedures: In our private vehicle, the children also use harnesses, and our PBS practitioner provided us with a special safety knife to quickly cut the harness in case of an emergency. What is the emergency escape procedure for harnessed children on SBS buses?

2. Safety Handbook: Is there an official SBS safety manual regarding the use of harnesses? If so, could you please provide a copy?

We appreciate your collaboration and your commitment to the children's safety. Looking forward to your guidance on these matters.

I'd appreciate your thoughts on this.

Thank you.

Warm regards
Hanyu

------------------ Original ------------------

From: Hanyu [redacted]>

Date: Thu, Mar 6, 2025 1:01 PM

To: [redacted]@pta.wa.gov.au>

Cc: SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>, [redacted]

Subject: Fw: Re: FW: RE: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

Dear [redacted],

Thank you for reaching out. I'd like to provide some background to clarify our request regarding [redacted]'s harness use.

Last year, the bus team suggested trying to remove the harnesses, as both children were doing very well on the bus. We agreed to give it a try, and thankfully, [redacted] successfully traveled without harnesses for some time without any issues. We were very happy with this progress, as it showed their increasing independence, and we truly appreciated the bus team's thoughtful support.

Unfortunately, after the long Christmas break (over two months), [redacted] suddenly started running on the bus again. The day after this behavior started, we immediately put the harness back on him to ensure safety. However, the current bus driver insisted that [redacted] must also wear a harness, citing SBS regulations—even though [redacted] had not run on the bus at all. We contacted SBS and were able to advocate for [redacted] to continue without a harness since he had been consistently sitting well.

When we first applied for school bus service two years ago, our provider was [redacted]. Unfortunately, within just one week, both children were suspended for running on the bus. SBS and [redacted] then required us to apply for harnesses, but the approval process took nearly 10 months. During this time, our children had no access to school transport. Because of how quickly this decision was made last time, I am particularly concerned about how behavioral reports are handled and whether we will have a chance to address any concerns before any decisions are made.

Since last year, [redacted] has been providing our bus service. Initially, both children traveled with harnesses, as that was the setup from the previous provider. I had multiple discussions with the bus team, asking if, when the children showed consistent good behavior, we could gradually remove the harnesses. Our PBS specialist had advised us that harnesses should be part of a fade-away plan, not a permanent solution.

However, when the harnesses were finally provided, we never received any official guidelines or a structured fade-away plan from SBS or [redacted]. We were not informed via email or phone about the process of reviewing harness use in the future. Naturally, we assumed that decisions about harness use could be made collaboratively between parents, the bus team, and the school, based on the children's observed behavior.

I believe that the previous bus team made the right call in supporting our children's gradual transition away from harnesses. However, it seems that neither SBS nor [redacted] provided clear guidelines on how to manage harness use and transition plans. As parents, we truly appreciate when bus staff work collaboratively with us to support our children's independence while ensuring their safety.

I wanted to provide this context to help clarify our position. Could you please confirm whether there are official guidelines regarding harness use and how decisions about removing or reinstating harnesses should be made? If there are no such guidelines in place, we would really appreciate guidance on how to proceed in the best interest of our children.

Thank you for your time and support. I look forward to your response.

Best regards,

Hanyu

------------------ Original ------------------

From: [redacted]@pta.wa.gov.au>

Date: Thu, Mar 6, 2025 10:45 AM

To: [redacted]

Cc: SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>

Subject: Re: FW: RE: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

Hi Hanyu

I have taken over this email trail as [redacted] (Contract Officer) is out of the office over the next couple of days.

In regard to the harnesses, are you requesting for both [redacted] to travel with no harness?

In your email it says [redacted] is travelling again in his harness, did he travel last year without one and was this communicated with you?

[redacted]

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------------------ Original ------------------

From: Hanyu [redacted]>
Sent: Friday, 28 February 2025 4:09 PM
To: [redacted] SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>
Subject: Re: RE: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

Hi [redacted]

I hope you're doing well.

I understand from the bus aides that [redacted] is sitting well with the seat belt. Could you please confirm whether he will still be required to wear the bus harness next Tuesday?

Regarding [redacted], I understand that he is back to using the harness. I would like to request a trial and a structured removal plan for him if possible. Could you please let me know if this can be arranged?

Additionally, I have some concerns about [redacted]'s safety while wearing the harness on the bus. In the event of an accident, I would like to understand the safety measures in place. Would it be possible to receive a document outlining the safety plan or any relevant guidelines regarding the use of the harness?

I appreciate your time and assistance, and I look forward to your response.

Thanks,

Hanyu

------------------ Original ------------------

From: [redacted]

Date: Fri, Feb 28, 2025 3:28 PM

To: [redacted] SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>[redacted]

Subject: Re: RE: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

[redacted]

Thank you very much for your assistance in this matter.

We as parents are very grateful for your help.

Regards.

[redacted]

From: [redacted]
Sent: Friday, 28 February 2025 3:06 PM
To: SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>; [redacted]
Subject: Re: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

You don't often get email from [redacted] Learn why this is important

Thanks [redacted]

Received and noted.

Regards

[redacted]

[redacted]

From: SBSMetroCentral <SBSMetroCentral@pta.wa.gov.au>
Sent: Friday, 28 February 2025 2:43:47 pm
To: [redacted]
Subject: Control Device Removal - [redacted]

Good afternoon,

[redacted] are currently traveling on the [redacted] **Bus** under the condition of using the approved control device. The family has requested consideration for the removal of [redacted]'s harness, as he has demonstrated improvement in his behaviour.

This request has been approved by School Bus Services on a trial basis with a review on an ongoing basis. However, if the previous behaviours reoccur, the decision will need to be re-evaluated.

Kind regards

[redacted]

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